

October 02nd, 2026
Week 40
Volume 282, Issue 1255

QUOTE
of the
WEEK

*"The greatest danger in times of turbulence is not the turbulence;
it is to act with yesterday's logic."*

- Peter Drucker

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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SCARCITY PUTS CHATTOGRAM ON TOP

The Gulf supplied another reminder this week that improved cargo flows do not equal normal shipping conditions. Several tankers were reportedly struck by unknown projectiles while transiting the Strait of Hormuz, followed by another tanker incident on October 1 in which a vessel caught fire, with the crew reported safe. Gulf crude movements have recovered significantly from earlier disruption, but passage risk, security and insurance remain firmly embedded in the voyage calculation.

Oil nevertheless eased into Friday as improving Middle East crude exports took some pressure out of the immediate supply story. Brent traded around USD 101 per barrel and WTI near USD 89, both below the extremes seen through September but still far removed from pre-conflict levels. The barrels are increasingly finding a route. The cost and risk of moving them remain another matter.

Dry freight finally gave some ground, although not enough to materially improve recycling supply. The Baltic Dry Index recovered modestly to 3,140 on Thursday after four consecutive declines, with Capesizes at 5,010, Panamaxs at 2,379 and Supramaxes at 1,794. The headline index is well below last week's levels, but earnings remain sufficiently attractive to keep many ageing vessels employed rather than heading for recycling. Softer freight is useful. Cheap freight would be more useful.

Currencies provided no common direction. The Indian Rupee weakened toward 96.3 against the Dollar before Friday's Gandhi Jayanti holiday, while the Pakistani Rupee remained around 277 and Bangladesh's interbank reference stayed close to 123.1. The Turkish Lira slipped beyond 49 to the Dollar. Pakistan delivered the week's fresh regional inflation number, with September CPI easing to 10.26% from August's 11.1%, providing some macro relief without materially altering Gadani's buying equation.

At the beaches, physical activity remains considerably healthier than the fresh sales pipeline. Chattogram has processed a substantial run of previously secured tonnage, including large gas and tanker units, while Gadani has also received and delivered vessels secured during its earlier buying run. Alang remained quieter through the local holiday period. The distinction that defined September therefore survives into October: yards are working, but today's owners are still not replenishing tomorrow's supply quickly enough.

The commercial hierarchy changed more decisively this week. Bangladesh moved ahead of Pakistan to reclaim the top position across the conventional board, with Chattogram recyclers bidding more aggressively for the very limited selection of available candidates. Pakistan moved into second place as part of its immediate requirement has already been satisfied by vessels secured and delivered over recent months, although underlying demand remains firm. India held its conventional levels and continues to find stronger interest in specialist tonnage. The important point is that the change in leadership has not been driven by a sudden increase in vessel supply. Buyers are competing harder because the opposite remains true. Bangladesh has taken the lead. The shortage remains the market.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 40 of 2026 are on Page 5.

Highlights:

• Bangladesh Leads

• Oil Eases

• Freight Firm

• Supply Thin

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BANGLADESH



CHATTOGRAM WANTS THE HULLS

Bids Rise

Chattogram has entered the final quarter with a noticeably stronger appetite and has now moved back to the top of the sub-continent board. After a quieter Q3 transaction cycle, end buyers are competing more aggressively for available units, pushing GMS indications higher across dry, tanker and container tonnage. The move is being driven primarily by requirement. Yard capacity is available, fresh candidates remain scarce and buyers increasingly have to improve their numbers when workable vessels appear.

Top Spot

The U-Ming controlled **ASIA CEMENT NO.3**, 3,520 LDT, provides a useful example of that returning appetite, having been reported sold at USD 446/LT on an 'as is' Taiwan basis. The basis is not directly comparable with a delivered Chattogram quotation, but the transaction confirms the commercial direction. At the same time, the waterfront remains considerably busier than the fresh sales sheet. SC Discovery XLVI, 2,428 LDT, was delivered September 30, while the substantial 28,773 LDT gas carrier Mutiara and 3,060 LDT refrigerated cargo vessel NEPT were delivered September 29. Merc, Phil, Haku and B-LPG Sophia all arrived September 28, adding further tonnage to an already active waterfront.

Supply Thin

Local steel supplied no equivalent rally. Bangladesh plate remained unchanged throughout the supplied period at BDT 64,000 per ton, approximately USD 522.24 per ton. This makes the rise in recycling indications more significant because the improved bid is not simply following a stronger domestic steel market. Requirement and candidate scarcity are doing more of the work. GMS indications have consequently moved to **USD 510/LDT for dry bulk, USD 530/LDT for tankers and USD 540/LDT for containers**, placing Bangladesh first on the Week 40 board. Chattogram now has the strongest conventional numbers, healthy waterfront activity and increasingly visible end-buyer appetite. What it still lacks is volume. The bid has returned to the top. The vessels have not returned with it.

MARKET SALE REPORTED

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	REPORTED PRICE
Asia Cement No.3	Cement Carrier	3,520	USD 446/LT ('as is' Taiwan)

INDIA



ALANG FINDS VALUE OFF THE BOARD

Alang was quieter from a transaction perspective this week, with local holidays interrupting activity just as the market entered October. The underlying commercial profile, however, remains familiar. India continues to offer respectable levels for specialist units, including LNGs, reefers, passenger ships and vessels carrying higher non-ferrous value, while conventional dry and tanker candidates remain difficult to secure against stronger sub-continent competition.

Holiday Quiet

The latest port position reflects activity already secured rather than a fresh buying run. The 28,214 LDT oil tanker Orion was delivered September 27, while the 8,110 LDT bulker Novaya Zemlya was delivered September 24. Both provide work to the waterfront, but neither changes this week's quieter transaction picture. The specialist lane remains India's stronger commercial route, even while fresh business pauses around the holiday calendar. Local steel provided considerably more movement. Alang plate opened the supplied period at INR 40,500 per ton, rose through INR 40,800 and INR 42,000, then reached INR 42,600 on September 30 before easing to INR 42,300. The supplied Dollar equivalent moved from approximately USD 422.67 to a high of USD 444.49 before settling near USD 439.25. The gain offers recyclers meaningful domestic support, although the Rupee's weakening toward 96.3 against the Dollar offsets part of that improvement. India's latest CPI remains August's 4.82%, with the September reading due later this month.

Steel Rebounds

The result is a market with better steel economics than last week but little reason to chase standard tonnage aggressively during a shortened trading period. GMS indications remain unchanged at **USD 465/LDT for dry bulk, USD 485/LDT for tankers and USD 495/LDT for containers**, leaving India third on the conventional board. Its strength remains vessel-specific. LNGs, reefers, passenger ships, non-ferrous-rich vessels and compliance-sensitive units continue to operate under a different valuation. The holiday quietened the waterfront. It did not change Alang's preferred lane.

Specialists Hold

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN



GADANI STEPS BACK NOT OUT

Lead Lost

Gadani has surrendered the top position this week as Bangladesh returned with the stronger conventional bid. The change follows several months in which Pakistani recyclers competed aggressively for scarce tonnage and secured a meaningful pipeline of vessels. As those ships have progressively arrived and delivered, some of the most urgent requirement has been satisfied. The resulting move lower should therefore be read as normalisation rather than a disappearance of demand.

Demand Firm

The latest port position supports that interpretation. The 11,060 LDT tanker Yue was delivered September 25, while the 7,381 LDT bulker Portland 11 arrived September 28 and the 5,143 LDT bulker Maestro arrived September 24. Lina F remains another earlier arrival. Gadani therefore has physical tonnage feeding the waterfront, which reduces the need for recyclers to chase every candidate with the intensity seen during August. Local fundamentals have not weakened materially. Pakistan plate remained unchanged throughout the supplied period at PKR 195,000 per ton, approximately USD 696.06 per ton. Currency has similarly remained stable around the recent 277 area to the Dollar. The adjustment in vessel pricing therefore reflects relative buying urgency rather than a deterioration in steel or currency support.

Steel Flat

GMS indications have moved to **USD 500/LDT for dry bulk, USD 520/LDT for tankers and USD 530/LDT for containers**, placing Pakistan second behind Bangladesh this week. Demand remains firm and suitable vessels can still attract competition, but Gadani is no longer paying as though every candidate must be secured immediately. Bangladesh has taken the lead. Pakistan still has the appetite.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY



ALIAGA STAYS IN ITS LANE

Aliaga enters October with little reason to alter the board. GMS indications remain unchanged from Week 39 as seasonal buying appetite holds at the improved September level, but there is no fresh transaction evidence this week requiring another adjustment. Turkey therefore remains in its established lane rather than entering a direct price contest with the sub-continent.

Board Holds

The currency backdrop remains the more obvious constraint. USD/TRY moved beyond 49.1 this week, extending the Lira's depreciation, while August CPI remains the latest official reading at 31.51%. The TCMB kept its one-week repo rate unchanged at 37% at its September meeting. Currency weakness therefore continues to erode Dollar purchasing power even as Aliaga recyclers maintain their post-summer appetite.

Lira Weakens

Turkey consequently remains dependent on geography, specialist tonnage, European regulatory access and Basel-compliant trades rather than conventional pricing competition. The board has improved from the summer lows. The structure of the market has not.

Niche Holds

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 40 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	Improving	510 / LDT	530 / LDT	540 / LDT
2	Pakistan	Softening	500 / LDT	520 / LDT	530 / LDT
3	India	Steady	465 / LDT	485 / LDT	495 / LDT
4	Turkey	Steady	300 / LDT	310-315 / LDT	325-330 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *72.55 million tonnes of CO₂-equivalent emissions estimated to have been avoided through ship recycling at Alang is equal to about 6.7% of the greenhouse-gas emissions generated by the entire global shipping sector in 2018.*
- *124.5 million barrels of oil estimated to have been saved through ship recycling at Alang would be enough to supply Reliance's Jamnagar refining complex at full design capacity for roughly 100 days.*
- *276 million cubic yards of landfill space estimated to have been saved through ship recycling at Alang is nearly 63 times the total 4.4 million cubic yards of concrete used in Hoover Dam and its appurtenant works.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
October 20 - Dussehra	October 08 – October 15 October 25 – November 01

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
20–21 October 2026 – Durga Puja	October 09 – October 12 October 25 – October 28

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	TURKEY
November 09 – Allama Iqbal Day	28–29 October 2026 – Republic Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of October 02, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Orion	28,214	Oil Tanker	<i>Delivered September 27</i>
2	Novaya Zemlya	8,110	Bulk Carrier	<i>Delivered September 24</i>

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of October 02, 2026

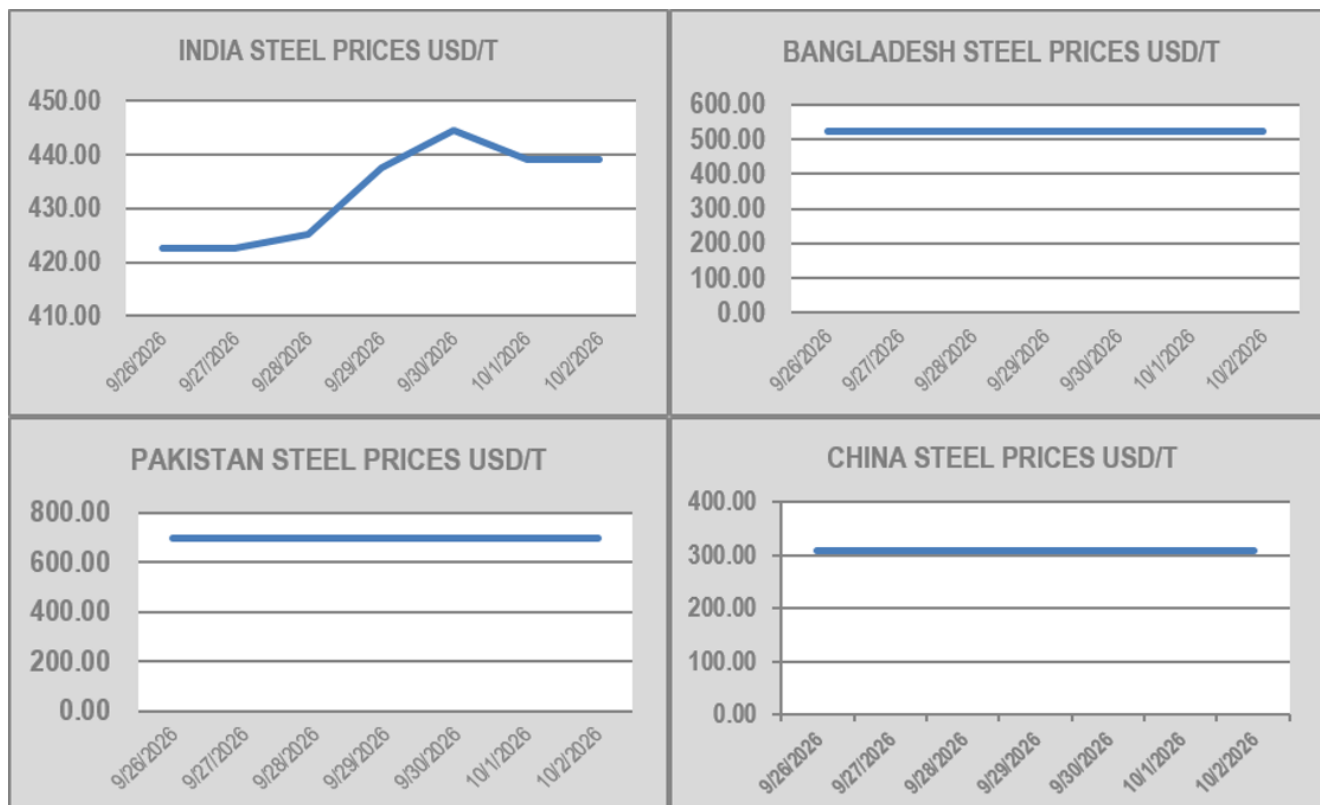
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	SC Discovery XLVI	2,428	LPG Tanker	<i>Delivered September 30</i>
2	Mutiara	28,773	Gas Carrier	<i>Delivered September 29</i>
3	NEPT	3,060	Refrigerated Cargo	<i>Delivered September 29</i>
4	Merc	490	Tug	Arrived September 28
5	Phil	3,544	Barge	Arrived September 28
6	Haku	11,304	Ro-Ro Ship	Arrived September 28
7	B-LPG Sophia (D/VSL)	3,421	LPG Tanker	Arrived September 28
8	Forever	16,708	Tanker	<i>Delivered September 27</i>
9	Fei	11,078	Tanker	<i>Delivered September 26</i>
10	Kushiro	1,040	General Cargo	<i>Delivered September 26</i>

GADANI - Port Position as of October 02, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Portland 11	7,381	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 28
2	Yue	11,060	Tanker	<i>Delivered September 25</i>
3	Maestro	5,143	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 24
4	Lina F	5,688	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 01

WHILE EXTREME CARE HAS BEEN TAKEN IN THE PREPARATION OF THIS REPORT, NO LIABILITY CAN BE ACCEPTED FOR ANY LOSS INCURRED IN ANY WAY WHATSOEVER BY ANY PERSON RELYING ON THE INFORMATION CONTAINED HEREIN.

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
9/26/2026	422.67	40,500.00	696.06	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
9/27/2026	422.67	40,500.00	696.06	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
9/28/2026	425.09	40,800.00	696.06	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
9/29/2026	437.59	42,000.00	696.06	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
9/30/2026	444.49	42,600.00	696.06	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
10/1/2026	439.25	42,300.00	696.06	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
10/2/2026	439.25	42,300.00	696.06	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46



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